ERIC HOWES

Technical Program Manager, Hardware | PMP | CSPO

Orem, UT | (801) 367-6743 | howesfamilyhomes@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/eric-howes-utah

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Program and product leader who has run hardware programs from prototype into production and owned software used in the field by thousands of people. At Lion Energy, Eric coordinated electrical, mechanical, firmware, software, and manufacturing teams to move the PPG2500 portable power station into production and take two more products through prototype, while working through tradeoffs on weight, battery configuration, packaging, and cost. At Aptive he was product owner for software used by more than 2,000 seasonal reps, coordinating about 12 developers across shared and overseas teams. He set up Agile, Scrum, Jira, and Confluence at Lion so leaders could see progress and blockers without chasing people. He wants to bring that hardware and field experience to feature programs on deployed, solar-powered site units.

CORE SKILLS

End-to-end program ownership | Hardware, firmware, and software coordination | Prototype, validation, and production milestones | Testing and certification (FCC, UL, drop test) | Risk, dependency, and schedule management | Backlog prioritization | Agile and Scrum | Jira and Confluence | Overseas manufacturing partners | Status reporting to leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Owner (promoted from Project Manager) | **Lion Energy** May 2024 – June 2025

American Fork, UT

Ran product development and technology programs for portable power stations, solar products, and accessories across engineering, QA, manufacturing partners in China and Vietnam, and the warehouse. Promoted from project manager to product owner after two months.

- Moved the PPG2500/PPG2500x portable power station program into production.
- Took the Peak product line and Safari cart through prototype development.
- Coordinated requirements, engineering design discussions, prototypes, testing, documentation, and production preparation with electrical, mechanical, firmware, software, and manufacturing stakeholders.
- Facilitated decisions when technical requirements conflicted with cost, packaging, weight, or manufacturing goals, including battery configuration and internal component placement.
- Coordinated testing, packaging validation, and certification activities for FCC, UL, and packaging drop tests.
- Introduced Agile and Scrum, organized Jira and Confluence workflows and statuses, and wrote a technology department handbook covering project management, QA, rollback, and launch procedures.
- Improved visibility into project progress, blockers, and cross-functional dependencies.
- Cut root cause investigation time on field returns from months to about one week and improved the return-to-resolution workflow about 50%, feeding defect data back to engineering and suppliers.

Product Owner (promoted from Project Manager) | **Aptive Environmental** Dec 2021 – May 2024

Provo, UT

Owned software products and enterprise technology programs for a national services company, working with engineering, operations, finance, sales, legal, and executive leadership.

- Product Owner for software used by more than 2,000 seasonal sales reps; managed requirements, backlog priorities, releases, and defect resolution.
- Coordinated about 12 technical development resources, including shared and overseas contributors.
- Coordinated a major data and technology migration covering planning, technical dependencies, APIs and integrations, testing, validation, and cutover, contributing to an estimated $3 million or more in annual recurring savings.
- Coordinated rollouts of Five9, Cresta AI sales coaching, CRM integrations, SMS, chatbot, and lead routing.
- Supported TCPA, consent, do-not-call, and PCI-related payment controls in the products the team built.

- Contributed to a reported 29% relative drop in onboarding dropout from a baseline of about 25%.

Inside Sales Representative | **Vivint Smart Home** June 2026 – Present
Provo, UT

- Sells connected smart-home and energy-management systems; leads a 70% attachment rate on the Smart Comfort program and keeps sales-to-install completion above 90%.

Project Manager (Independent Contractor) | **H and H Homes** June 2025 – June 2026
Lehi, UT

- Ran residential construction jobs start to finish; put SOPs, inventory tracking, equipment maintenance, fleet management, and quality and safety controls in place.

Area Manager, Post-Sale Operations | **ION Solar** June 2021 – Dec 2021
Las Vegas and Arizona markets (based in Orem, UT)

- Tracked residential solar projects from sale through installation, inspection, utility requirements, and permission to operate; contributed to a 57% increase in PTO processing rate.

Junior Project Manager | **K-Designers** Jan 2020 – June 2021
West Valley City, UT

- Scheduled crews and up to ten contractors on remodeling jobs, and matched material orders to project schedules.

Analytics Manager (four progressive roles) | **Vivint Smart Home** Jan 2011 – Jan 2019
Provo, UT

Moved from inside sales to account manager, analytics manager, and enterprise partner sales and training.

- Coordinated a four-person analytics team that built sales and installation dashboards, supporting a reported 34% relative improvement in sales-to-install conversion.
- Built risk scoring to flag installations likely to cancel or stall.
- Helped grow an installation-support department from more than 20 reps to more than 50.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- Lead Home Manager, Lindon Care and Training (2009–2011); Fabrication Worker, AA Machine and Welding (2007–2009); Concrete Foreman, Paramount Homes (2004–2006).

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Business Administration (Business Management), Utah Valley University
Project Management Professional (PMP), Project Management Institute, 2021
Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), 2023